To: PPS Board of Education
From: Virginia La Forte, Chair, Facilities Improvement & Operations Committee
RE: May 27, 2026 Committee Report
Date: August 4, 2026

COMMITTEE REPORT

The committee was unable to establish a quorum.

On the day of the meeting, I was notified that the Director Chase-Miller and Director DePass would be unable to attend the meeting. Given the significance of the agenda items including and the preparation by staff, I elected to continue the meeting for informational purposes. No committee action was taken.

Public Comment – Indian Education

Lisa Jackson Spotted-Elk, a longtime advocate for Native American students and families, testified during public comment.

She raised several concerns, including:

- Continued concern that Indian Education has not been incorporated into the Jefferson High School planning process.
- Concern that the program has been displaced without a permanent long-term location and the Native community has not received a meaningful update.
- Lack of meaningful engagement with the District.

Following the meeting, I added Indian Ed to the June 24, 2026 FIO agenda for follow-up. Staff declined to present, citing no update. Dr. Franco has indicated, "I'd be happy to sit down with you to discuss conversations we have had with the RISE team, the schools team, FACE and the Native community as it is a bit nuanced with the timeline as well as possible future locations. The team has been engaging with the Native community and there will be a robust engagement plan moving forward."

Follow-up: Add to future FIO Agenda to discuss engagement plan.

Pool RFP Process

This item was added to agenda following Board approval of several "not-to-exceed" contracts utilizing Pool Requests for Proposals (Pool RFPs).

During previous Board discussions, RISE indicated that Pool RFPs had been used previously within PPS. The District was unable to locate similar examples following the meeting, prompting this discussion.

Director of Purchasing & Contracting Paul Williams provided an excellent overview of the procurement process and acknowledged that while Pool RFPs are not new, "pools of this size and this quantity are different for us," adding that in terms of "size and scale-wise," this approach is new to PPS.

Discussion

The presentation highlighted operational efficiencies associated with Pool RFPs. But, it also raised governance and oversight questions that remain unresolved.

During both the April 14 Regular Board meeting and subsequent discussions, vendors responding to the Pool RFPs submitted questions about the expanded scope of these procurements and how they differed from previous district practices.

My primary concern is governance and transparency.

Because the Board approves the overall pool rather than individual task orders, contracts that would otherwise require Board approval in response to the District's $150,000 threshold, will instead be awarded administratively without subsequent Board review. While this may improve administrative efficiency, it also reduces Board visibility into significant expenditures.

It's my opinion that the Board should consider an approved reporting process that provides regular visibility into:

- Task orders exceeding the Board approval threshold of $150,000;;
- Remaining contract capacity.

Follow-up: Staff has added a new pricing bid information sheet for each vendor to relevant Pool RFPs that had not been included in prior Board materials, improving transparency during the approval process. Would recommend Board training on Pool RFPs and a system reporting process for contracts/task orders that exceed $150,000

Athletic Facilities Update

Staff provided updates on several athletic facility projects.

Grant Bowl

- Field lighting installation is complete.
- Staff is awaiting confirmation of the date the lights will be energized for community use.
- Planning and land use work for the next phase—including restrooms, concessions, seating, and other site improvements—is expected to begin during the second half of this year.
- A Type III land use application is anticipated by year-end.

- Staff indicated the previous master plan will not necessarily be used and that a new design team will be assembled.

I expressed concern that perimeter fencing should be explored to address crowd control and meet OSAA playoff requirements. Because Grant operates as an open campus and the lease requires continued community access, this should be developed through a collaborative community engagement process involving both the school and neighborhood.

I also emphasized that, unlike the lighting project, this phase begins with essentially no permanent spectator amenities and should include robust public engagement before design decisions are finalized.

Marshall Campus

- Track, field, and tennis improvements are complete.
- Phase 2 is underway and includes a new multi-use field for soccer, baseball, and softball.
- Staff anticipates submitting land use applications in Q4, with hearings and decisions targeted for Q2 2027.

Jackson Middle School

- Project remains in the design phase.

Powell Park

- Lease negotiations continue.
- Timing has become a significant concern. Without an executed lease in the near future, field improvements could be delayed..

Jefferson High School

- Athletic field construction has begun.

West Sylvan

- Land use application is in progress.

Athletic Swing Sites

The committee requested an updated report on athletic swing sites associated with upcoming high school modernizations. Athletics staff prepared a comprehensive spreadsheet that should serve as a useful reference for the Board and community.

Bond Audit Update

Year 6 Recommendation #13 (Mislabeled in FIO Presentation)

Recommendation #13 calls for comparing staffing capacity with projected bond workload to identify staffing gaps and determine whether resources are under- or over-utilized. The recommendation was originally identified for closure in January 2026 by RISE.

The Bond Performance Auditor has reopened it with the following comment:

Our Bond Auditor's current comment states:

"No comparison of capacity to workload with gap identification was provided. Recommendation remains in progress."

In practical terms, this means the District has not yet demonstrated that it has compared expected bond work to available staffing resources or identified potential capacity gaps or excesses.

During the meeting, staff indicated it could potentially be closed with comments in April; however, it remains open.

Follow-up: Assume this will be addressed in pending Bond Audit.

BAC Charter

Greg DiLoreto, the Bond Accountability Committee (BAC) Chair, commented that the BAC had reviewed their proposed charter revisions developed with BAC members, FIO input, and input from PPS legal team. The BAC recommended it be sent to the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee for review.

Discussion included whether the BAC should receive copies of program-level and project-specific Program Management Plans containing key performance indicators. Staff indicated they would confirm that BAC members have access to those materials. There were questions regarding KPIs referenced in the Committee Charge section, and whether bond expenditure testing should be included in the district's financial audit process.

Director La Forte stated the BAC Charter would go to the Board for approval—via the BAC, not FIO—at the June 9th meeting.

Follow-up: The BAC Charter was adopted by the Board with a 7-0 vote.